

FIELD LIBRARY / FULL FIELD GUIDE

Wildfire

NATURAL HAZARDS / EDITION 2026-10-02

QUICK ANSWER / START HERE

Check evacuation notices for your address. Leave promptly when ordered, using the current official route; do not delay for possessions. If a fire threatens your escape or you are trapped, call emergency services with your precise location.

Do now.

**Confirm your zone**

01

Use fire agency and emergency management alerts rather than old perimeter maps.

**Gather people and pets**

02

Take essential medicines, identification, keys and phone power without delaying departure.

**Use official routes**

03

Smoke and closures can change quickly; do not drive into heavy smoke or flames.

**Report your destination**

04

Tell an out-of-area contact where you are going and follow shelter instructions.

Keep the plan moving.

IF HELP IS UNAVAILABLE

Leave before the only usable route is threatened. If no official update is reachable, act on visible nearby fire, rapidly worsening conditions and verified local information rather than waiting for an order. Do not drive into smoke with unknown visibility or through flames.

Watch for.

A smoke-control room cannot protect you from a fire approaching the building.

People & practical needs.

Assign one person to dependents and pets and another to transport and contacts. Keep essential medicine, access aids and car keys together. Agree on a reunion place that is outside the threatened area, with a second option if access changes.

Keep essentials within reach.

Prioritize supplies named in this guide that are usable by the person who needs them. Keep the checklist and relevant contact details accessible. Check carrying capacity, storage and equipment instructions in advance; collecting equipment must not delay the immediate protective action.

Next decisions.

Return only when reentry is allowed. Check for damaged utilities, hot debris and continuing smoke.

Questions in the field.

When should a household with access needs leave?

Arrange transport, medicine, pets and equipment before routes become crowded or smoky. Leaving early can reduce the difficulty of moving a person who needs extra time; verify the route and destination rather than relying on a single notification.

Can a respirator make a road safe?

No. A particle respirator does not protect against heat, every gas or a blocked road. Smoke protection is one part of the decision; active fire, access and changing wind can make travel unsafe regardless of a mask.

YOUR SITUATION / PRIVATE WORKSHEET

TIME / LOCATION / CHANGING CONDITIONS

PEOPLE / ACCESS OR MEDICAL NEEDS

NEXT ACTION / PERSON RESPONSIBLE

Sources & limits.

Civilian educational guidance. Linked references may use U.S. emergency systems; local warning methods, laws, services and conditions differ.

Source-linked editorial guidance. Not independent clinical or specialist certification. Training and product-specific instructions remain essential.

Wildfire · official guidance

<https://www.ready.gov/wildfires>

Full guide: <https://ospreyzero.com/emergencies/wildfire/>

Content updated 2026-10-02. Saved guidance cannot provide live alerts.